

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9
 ♥ K 9 6 3
 ♦ 10 8 6 5
 ♣ J 4 3

♠ A Q J 6 4 2

♥ A 7

♦ J 7 2

♣ A 8



♠ 8 3

♥ Q J 10 4

♦ A 9 4

♣ K Q 10 5

♠ K 7 5

♥ 8 5 2

♦ K Q 3

♣ 9 7 6 2

There is only one reason that NORTH should not overcall with 1 ♠. He is too strong. The maximum strength of an overcall is 16 points. Above that you should double.

So NORTH doubles, and after SOUTH bids 2 ♣, NORTH bids 2 ♠. This shows an overcall type hand, but with 17 or more points.

SOUTH has fine trump support and 8 points so she bids a confident 4 ♠.

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	Dbl	Pass	2 ♣
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 5 4
♥ J 10 9 2
♦ J 10 8 6
♣ 5 3

♠ Q J 2
♥ A K 4 3
♦ 7 4
♣ K Q 8 2



♠ A 7 6
♥ Q 8 5
♦ A 9 3 2
♣ 10 9 4

♠ K 9 8 3
♥ 7 6
♦ K Q 5
♣ A J 7 6

SOUTH has 13 points but has no bid over 1 ♦.

NORTH can make a Takeout Double, so he does.

SOUTH now cue-bids ♦ to show opening hand strength.

NORTH shows his ♥ suit, SOUTH doesn't like it.

SOUTH shows her ♠ suit, NORTH doesn't like it.

NORTH shows his ♣ suit, SOUTH likes it fine, but decides 3NT will be easier than 5♣.

West	North	East	South
		1 ♦	Pass
Pass	Dbl	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	2 ♥	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	3 ♣	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 6
♥ Q 6 5
♦ J 7 5 4
♣ K 10 6 2

♠ K 8 2
♥ K J 10 2
♦ K Q 9
♣ Q 8 3



♠ A J 10 7 4
♥ A 7 3
♦ A 8 6
♣ 9 5

♠ Q 5 3
♥ 9 8 4
♦ 10 3 2
♣ A J 7 4

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

All Pass

1 ♠ by North

EAST would have had a great opening 1 ♠ bid. But when NORTH opened 1 ♠ in front of him he was hornswaggled. He couldn't bid any other suit, he couldn't bid 1NT and he sure couldn't bid ♠s. So he must pass.

And so does everybody else pass.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 10 4
♥ K 9 6 3
♦ A 4 2
♣ A K J 9

♠ A 8 2

♥ J 5 2

♦ K 9 8 6

♣ 7 5 3



♠ 6

♥ A Q 10 8

♦ J 10 7 5

♣ Q 10 8 4

♠ K Q J 9 7 5 3

♥ 7 4

♦ Q 3

♣ 6 2

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♣

3 ♠

All Pass

3 ♠ by South

If East had passed, SOUTH would have opened with a preemptive 3 ♠.

She should make the same bid with the same hand AFTER the opponents open. And she makes it for the same reason, to describe her hand and to take away bidding space from the opponents.

NORTH treats it just like a Preemptive 3-bid, even though it is now called a Weak Jump Overcall. In this case, NORTH passes.

Board 5

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 6 3
♥ A K 7
♦ 9 4 2
♣ A 10 7 5

♠ A J 10 8 5

♥ 6 3

♦ A J 10 8 5

♣ 3



♠ Q 4
♥ 10 9 8 2
♦ K Q 7
♣ K Q J 2

♠ K 7 2

♥ Q J 5 4

♦ 6 3

♣ 9 8 6 4

NORTH has 12 points, but with two 5-card suits worthy of an overcall. There isn't really a right and wrong here, but it usually works out best to overcall in the higher-ranking suit. That leaves open the possibility of bidding the second suit later.

In this Deal, after NORTH overcalls 1♠, that later possibility never happens because everybody should pass.

West

1♣

North

1♠

*East**South*

All Pass

1♠ by North